

CASE 6 - Home for Dependent Elderly People and Nursing Home / Dominique Coulon & Associés

Number of Floors: 2

This facility includes 2 above-ground levels, confirmed by the architectural drawings and descriptive texts on ArchDaily.

Level 1

(1) Vocabulary Extraction

- Entrance hall
- Dining area
- Multipurpose activity rooms
- Kitchen
- Administrative offices
- Medical room
- Storage rooms
- Toilets
- Elevators
- Stairwells
- Central courtyard
- Corridors

(2) Quantity Estimation

- Entrance hall 1
- Dining area 1
- Activity rooms 2
- Kitchen 1
- Offices 2

- Medical room 1
- Storage rooms approx. 3
- Toilets approx. 4
- Elevators 2
- Stairwells 2
- Courtyard 1
- Corridors multiple

(3) Spatial Relationship Descriptions

- The entrance hall leads directly to key communal functions such as the dining and activity rooms.
- The kitchen is directly adjacent to the dining area, optimizing food service.
- Administrative and medical services are located nearby the entrance for accessibility.
- A central courtyard provides visual and spatial relief, enhancing daylight and orientation.
- Corridors serve as connective spines, allowing fluid circulation between all spaces.

(4) Overall Spatial Impression

The ground floor is organized as a service and communal hub, emphasizing interaction, supervision, and accessibility. The spatial logic centers around a courtyard, promoting openness and clarity of movement.

Level 2

(1) Vocabulary Extraction

- Residential units
- Shared lounges
- Toilets
- Elevators
- Stairwells
- Corridors

(2) Quantity Estimation

- Residential units approx. 30
- Shared lounges 2
- Toilets approx. 4
- Elevators 2
- Stairwells 2
- Corridors multiple

(3) Spatial Relationship Descriptions

- Residential units are arrayed along double-loaded corridors for efficiency and orientation.
- Shared lounges are placed at key intersections for social interaction.
- Toilets are distributed evenly for resident convenience.
- Vertical circulation (elevators and stairs) is centrally positioned to connect both floors.

(4) Overall Spatial Impression

The second floor functions primarily as the living zone, balancing privacy within units with the opportunity for communal activities in lounges. The layout supports autonomy and intuitive navigation for elderly residents.

P2 Photographs / Renders Interpretation

1. Design Vocabulary Extraction

- Cantilevered volumes
- Large glazed openings
- Colored faade surfaces (notably red and white)
- Timber interior finishes
- Central courtyard

2. Atmospheric Description

The atmosphere blends calmness and warmth. Natural light floods the interiors through generous glazing. The mix of wood and color gives a vibrant yet comforting ambiance suitable for elderly care.

3. Spatial Composition or Hierarchy

The design is structured around a central courtyard, organizing programmatic masses in a radial or articulated layout. Repetition and rhythm in faade openings reinforce spatial order.

4. Design Intent Reading

The design promotes dignity and spatial clarity. The use of color, transparency, and daylight reflects a commitment to mental well-being and a sense of home rather than institutionalization.

5. Contextual Relationship

The building nestles within a gently sloping site, with low profiles and articulated volumes ensuring harmony with the rural Normandy landscape. Openings and outdoor spaces frame views and connect the interior with nature.